

LEH (#267677)**Author(s)**

This pre-registration is currently anonymous to enable blind peer-review.
It has one author.

Pre-registered on:
2026/01/13 07:02 (PT)

1) Have any data been collected for this study already?

No, no data have been collected for this study yet.

2) What's the main question being asked or hypothesis being tested in this study?

Are people overconfident in their estimates of life expectancies?

Each participant will answer 10 question of the form: "Given that an American male has lived at least 10 years, estimate how old he will be (in years) when he dies."

3) Describe the key dependent variable(s) specifying how they will be measured.

The study will collect two measures:

1. estimates of life expectancy
2. certainty that each estimate is close to the truth

4) How many and which conditions will participants be assigned to?

The study will vary 3 things orthogonally:

Age attained (1, 10, 20, 30, 40, 50, 60, 70, 80, 90, or 100 years)

Gender of target

Difficulty: Proximity to truth (1, 5, 10, or 20 years)

5) Specify exactly which analyses you will conduct to examine the main question/hypothesis.

We will compute overconfidence by taking reported certainty (for each item) and subtracting from it the actual probability (based on the Social Security Period Life Table <https://www.ssa.gov/oact/STATS/table4c6.html>). We will compare overconfidence across the four difficulty conditions.

6) Describe exactly how outliers will be defined and handled, and your precise rule(s) for excluding observations.

The questionnaire will include a catpcha to exclude bots, and two attention check questions. Participants who fail them or who complete the survey in under two minutes will be excluded from analysis.

7) How many observations will be collected or what will determine sample size? No need to justify decision, but be precise about exactly how the number will be determined.

I will open the survey to 100 participants.

8) Anything else you would like to pre-register? (e.g., secondary analyses, variables collected for exploratory purposes, unusual analyses planned?)

We will compare confidence and actual probability across all questions and participants to obtain an overall measure of overconfidence.